



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Dhole!

Endangered

Facts • Colour • Activities

Dhole Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Cuon alpinus
Status:	Endangered
Where they live:	India, Bhutan, Nepal, China, Laos, Vietnam, Indonesia
Habitat:	Tropical forests, alpine steppes, and scrub forests across South and Southeast Asia
Diet:	Carnivore — deer, gaur, wild boar; hunts cooperatively in packs
Weight:	10–21 kg
Lifespan:	About 10 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 2,215 mature individuals worldwide

Amazing Facts ■

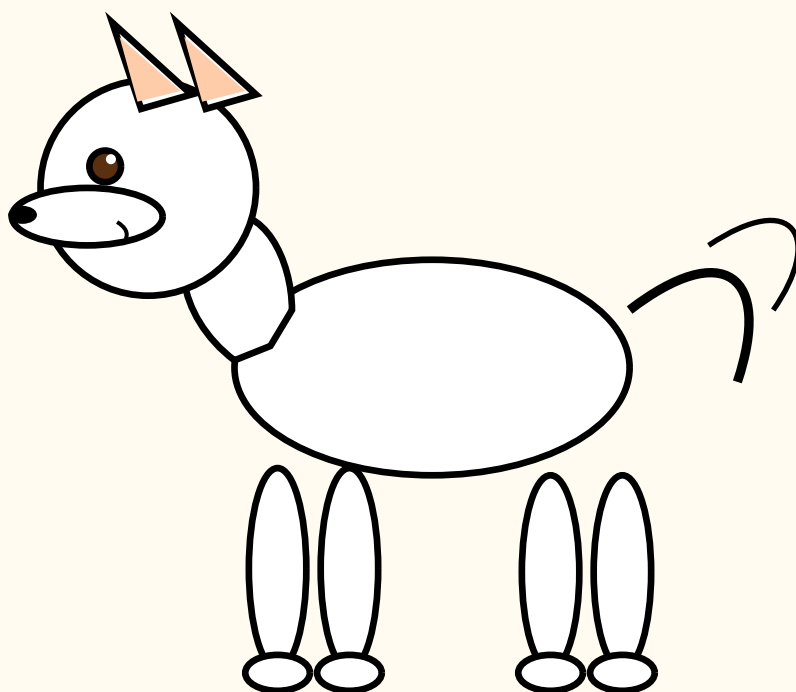
- Dholes are called 'whistling dogs' — they communicate using high-pitched whistles.
- A pack can bring down prey 10 times their own size, like gaur — the world's largest wild cattle.
- Dholes have disappeared from over 82% of their historic range — including Russia and Korea.
- Pups are raised communally — every adult in the pack helps feed and protect them.
- Dholes are excellent swimmers and often drive prey into rivers to exhaust it.
- Despite being fierce hunters, dholes are naturally very shy and rarely seen by humans.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Habitat destruction and deforestation	CRITICAL
2	Prey depletion from poaching	HIGH
3	Persecution by farmers protecting livestock	HIGH
4	Disease spread from domestic dogs	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Dhole

Dholes have rust-red or tawny fur on their back, fading to white or cream on the underside. Their bushy tail has a dark tip.



Activities

Word Search — find all 8 words!

R	W	Z	R	N	U	I	E	F	F	E	J
I	H	W	H	G	R	W	M	D	F	Q	A
L	L	I	Z	R	J	M	S	Y	E	G	S
R	P	R	E	D	A	T	O	R	N	E	I
G	U	X	U	E	L	B	Y	V	D	X	A
T	R	X	D	I	T	E	Y	E	A	N	H
F	R	G	A	U	L	F	L	D	N	C	U
H	I	Z	N	T	Q	O	M	Q	G	A	N
W	U	F	S	F	H	R	A	W	E	N	T
H	U	I	V	D	L	E	H	C	R	I	I
T	H	P	V	D	O	S	Z	B	E	D	N
W	M	Y	G	F	H	T	S	L	D	X	G

DHOLE	PREDATOR	ENDANGERED	FOREST
ASIA	WHISTLE	HUNTING	CANID

Match It Up!

Dhole		working together to catch prey
Pack hunting		member of the dog family
Gaur		also called the whistling dog
Deforestation		world's largest wild cattle
Canid		cutting down forests

Fill in the Blanks!

- Dholes are also known as _____ dogs.
- They hunt in _____ to catch large prey.
- Dholes live in forests across _____ Asia.
- There are fewer than _____ mature dholes left in the wild.

Answers: whistling | packs | South and Southeast | 2,215

Zoo Explorers packs are free to print and share. New animals at zooexplorers.com